YOGI KEEPS THE CROWN

UP's Yogi Adityanath continues his dream run as the country's favourite chief minister but his numbers are dropping

By KAUSHIK DEKA

A key reason for the BJP's disappointing performance in the recent Lok Sabha election was the setback in Uttar Pradesh, where it dropped to just 33 seats, almost half its count of 62 in 2019. The poor showing has sparked internal discussions within the party about the "effectiveness" of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. Public opinion regarding the UP leader, though, remains strong. For the past nine Mood of the Nation surveys, Adityanath has been ranked No. 1 among chief ministers by respondents nationwide.

The 'Bulldozer baba' has established himself as one of India's most popular political figures, largely due to his tough-on-crime image and strong Hindutva identity. What might be of concern, however, is the decline in his approval ratings—only 33 per cent respondents now consider him the best chief minister, down from 46 per cent in February. Adityanath's position remains strong only due to the significant gap between him and his closest competitor, the jailed Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal, of nearly 20 percentage points. Among the top 10 most popular chief ministers, only three—Adityanath, Kejriwal and West Bengal's Mamata Banerjee—were rated as the best CM by more than five per cent of the respondents.

Meanwhile, a different story is unfolding in the Northeast. In Sikkim, second-term CM Prem Singh Tamang, who leads the Sikkim Krantikari Morcha, has significantly strengthened his position within his home state. After sweeping the assembly election in April, Tamang now enjoys substantial support, with 58 per cent of the respondents in Sikkim satisfied with his performance. The only other CM to garner more than 50 per cent support within his home state is Assam's Himanta Biswa Sarma while the biggest increase in approval comes for Mamata, with 46 per cent of the respondents backing her performance, despite the intense flak over the rape-murder of a doctor in Kolkata.

When it comes to popularity within their respective states, BJP chief ministers dominate the top 10 list, securing five spots. No Congress CM figures among the top 10, raising questions about their governance model. ■

Q. Most popular CM (across India)

Respondents across 30 states were asked to rate the best-performing CM in the country



2 ARVIND KEJRIWAL
Delhi
13.8 [19.6]



3 MAMATA BANERJEE
West Bengal
9.1 [8.4]



4 M.K. STALIN
Tamil Nadu
4.7 [5.5]



5 CHANDRABABU NAIDU
Andhra Pradesh
4.6 [NA]



1 PREM SINGH TAMANG
Sikkim
55.7 [26]

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